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The textile product passport: what is decided, what is not, and what Turkish suppliers can prepare now

The EU framework for digital product passports is in force. The textile rules are not yet written, but EU buyers are already asking for the data.

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Executive summary

1. The Ecodesign for Sustainable Products Regulation (ESPR), Regulation (EU) 2024/1781, has applied since July 2024. It sets the framework for digital product passports, and the EU registry for passport identifiers was due by 19 July 2026. Textiles and apparel are a priority product group in the Commission's ESPR working plan, with a delegated act planned for 2027.
2. Requirements in a product act apply no earlier than 18 months after it enters into force, so a mandatory textile passport is unlikely before 2029. Other parts of ESPR already apply: since 19 July 2026 large companies may not destroy unsold apparel, clothing accessories and footwear in the EU.
3. The textile act will decide which data fields, data carrier and level of detail are required. The likely content is already visible: product identification, fibre composition, origin, the companies involved, care and repair, and end-of-life information. Most of it sits with the supplier, often with subcontractors.

What is already decided

ESPR requires each passport to be linked to a persistent unique product identifier through a machine-readable data carrier, such as a 2D code, and to be accessible to customers, authorities and other operators according to set access rights. The EU registry holds the identifiers, not the passport content itself.

European standards for passport identifiers, data carriers and interoperability have been developed by CEN and CENELEC at the Commission's request. They will shape how passport data is structured and exchanged, whichever fields the textile act selects.

The ban on destroying unsold apparel, clothing accessories and footwear applies to large companies from 19 July 2026 and to medium-sized companies from 19 July 2030. Large companies must also disclose each year how many unsold products they discard. Buyers are already adjusting order sizes and replenishment as a result.

What the textile act will decide

The delegated act for textiles and apparel will select the information requirements from the menu in ESPR, choose the data carrier and where it sits on the product, and decide whether passports

are set per model, per batch or per item. It will also define who may read or update the data and how long the passport must remain available.

Until it is adopted, any supplier claiming to be passport-compliant is guessing. The sound approach is to build data that will be needed under any reasonable outcome, and to avoid investing early in a specific carrier or platform.

What Turkish suppliers can prepare now

A model-level data structure that holds fibre composition as required by the EU Textile Labelling Regulation, recycled content, the country and company for each processing step (spinning, weaving or knitting, dyeing and finishing, making up), and care instructions.

Data from subcontractors. Dyeing, printing and finishing are often outsourced, and that is where most data gaps appear. Agreeing now what subcontractors record and pass on is cheaper than chasing it per order later.

One structure for several requests. The same supply chain data answers EU buyers' forced labour questions under Regulation (EU) 2024/3015, which applies from 14 December 2027, as well as chemicals and PFAS restrictions and sustainability questionnaires. Building it once avoids answering each request from scratch.

Product identifiers. Many EU retailers already use GTINs for each model and size. Consistent identifiers on the supplier side make any later passport much easier to populate.

Five common misreadings

"The textile passport starts in 2027." 2027 is when the Commission plans to adopt the act. Requirements apply at least 18 months later.

"The passport is the brand's problem." The brand places the product on the market, but much of the data sits with suppliers and their subcontractors.

"We need a passport platform now." The carrier and fields are not yet decided. Clean, structured data is the investment that keeps its value.

"The destruction ban does not affect suppliers." It changes how large EU buyers order, with smaller initial orders and more replenishment.

"This only matters for apparel brands." Home textiles and technical textiles may also be covered, depending on the scope of the act.

Questions for the leadership team

1. Which of our EU customers have asked for fibre, origin or processing data per model, and in what format?
2. Do we hold processing-step data for subcontracted dyeing, printing and finishing?
3. Can we produce a model-level record with fibre composition, origin and care information for our main lines?
4. Are our product identifiers consistent with those our EU customers use?
5. How have large EU buyers changed order sizes and replenishment since July 2026?
6. Could one data structure answer passport, forced labour and chemicals requests?
7. Who owns product data in the company?

What a good first step produces

A useful first step is a product data and order-pattern review for the customers and lines that carry most of your EU sales: what data exists per model, where it sits, what subcontractors hold, and how key buyers are changing their orders. It should leave the leadership team with a prioritised plan that does not depend on guessing the final passport rules.

Ganrich Advisory runs this as a focused review with your sales, planning and quality teams. We do not certify products or supply chains, and testing comes from accredited laboratories. We share the working method in a conversation rather than in print, because it depends on the business.

Start a conversation

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About this paper. This paper reflects official sources checked on 26 October 2026. It is general information, not legal, customs, tax or engineering advice. Rules, thresholds and dates change; confirm them against official sources before acting. It describes no client work or results.

Sources: Regulation (EU) 2024/1781 on ecodesign requirements for sustainable products (ESPR): eur-lex.europa.eu/eli/reg/2024/1781/oj · European Commission, ESPR and Energy Labelling working plan 2025–2030 (April 2025): commission.europa.eu · Regulation (EU) No 1007/2011 on textile fibre names and labelling: eur-lex.europa.eu/eli/reg/2011/1007/oj · Regulation (EU) 2024/3015 prohibiting products made with forced labour: eur-lex.europa.eu/eli/reg/2024/3015/oj

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